



MSMEs hit by Covid-19 pandemic to get additional assistance

The Union Cabinet has approved additional funding of up to ₹ 3,000 billion through the Guaranteed Emergency Credit Line (GECL) for the MSME sector hit hard by the Covid-19 pandemic. For this purpose, a corpus of ₹ 416 billion will be provided by the central government spread over the current and the next three financial years to provide a guarantee against loan losses. Interest rates under the scheme are capped at 9.25 per cent for banks and financial institutions and fourteen per cent for non-banking financial companies (NBFCs).

The National Credit Guarantee

Trustee Company (NCGTC) will provide 100 per cent guarantee against losses on loans advanced to eligible micro, small, and medium enterprise (MSME) and MUDRA borrowers under the scheme which is open till October 31.

All MSME borrower accounts with outstanding credit of up to ₹ 0.25 billion as on February 29, which were less than or equal to sixty days past due as on that date, and with an annual turnover of up to ₹ 1 billion, would be eligible for GECL funding. They can get up to twenty per cent fresh loans of their entire outstanding credit.

Fingerprint-on-display sensors to reach 400 million units in 2020

Global shipments of fingerprint-on-display (FoD) sensors expanded by nearly a factor of eight in 2019 as these devices replaced conventional silicon-based capacitive chips in smartphones. A total of 228.3 million FoD sensors were shipped in 2019, according to Omdia.

“With FoD sensors having reached the sweet spot for market pricing, FoD shipments are expected to continue rising at a tremendous rate in 2020, expanding to more than 400 million

units,” reads Omdia’s official statement.

Besides Apple, most smartphone brands have adopted FoD as an advanced bio-metric identification technology to replace capacitive fingerprint chips. More than seventy smartphone models integrated FoD in 2019. FoD can offer the same type of user experience of fingerprint recognition experience as capacitive chips, without requiring any learning. The invisibility of FoD also gives smart-

Battery technology market to reach \$194 billion by 2027

The battery technology market is estimated to reach 194 billion dollars by 2027, as per a report by Acumen Research and Consulting. Further, the market is expected to grow at a CAGR of eleven per cent. The report says that Asia-Pacific is driving market demand. It has several developing economies

with substantial natural and human capital. It also says that India and China are projected to be major investment hubs for battery technology companies during the forecast period.

“Asia Pacific is expected to be the leading player in the battery technology market due to rapid urbanisation

ON THE move



Silicon Labs appoints Karuna Annavajjala as CIO

Silicon Labs has announced the appointment of Karuna Annavajjala as chief information officer. As CIO, Annavajjala will oversee information technology (IT) services for Silicon Labs’ global business operations including strategic planning, infrastructure services, business application platforms, cyber security and data privacy, and IT service delivery. Prior to joining Silicon Labs, Annavajjala served as CIO of corporate functions at AIG. She has also worked as the executive director of technology delivery at TIAA where she developed IT transformation strategies, managed multiple global technology and professional services teams, and established offshore capabilities.

MSME Ministry appoints Arvind Kumar as new secretary

Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) has appointed Arvind Kumar as the new secretary. Prior to this appointment, Sharma was serving as additional secretary in Prime Minister’s Office (PMO). He is 1988 batch IAS officer of Gujarat cadre. He has also worked for the Gujarat government at various positions including field and policy level and has extensive experience of handling the portfolios of regulatory and developmental administration.

phone makers the freedom to offer a handset design without any notches.

The FoD technologies are mature and affordable, so the average selling price of a fingerprint module ASP can be as low as three to four dollars, which is more cost-effective than alternative 3D facial recognition technologies.

and consumption spending in countries such as India and China, which are projected to increase demand for advanced technology, due to the current opportunities to grow the market during the forecast period,” the report mentions.

The major factors that will drive the market growth include growing demand for electric and hybrid-electric cars, strong demand for clean energy storage technology. It